

A new hope

Star Ocean: The Last Hope was a game that was launched for the Xbox 360, but will now see the light of day on the PS3 in Feb 2010, as it was announced by Square Enix, the developers

The affordable quad

AMD has released the first of its kind sub \$100 quad core processors. The Athlon II X4 620 and 630 are 45nm manufactured quad-core processor, previously codenamed Propus

Indian govt plans to block all Internet telephony for security purposes

Cheap international calls over VoIP (Voice Over Internet Protocol) may soon be a thing of the past for Indians as the Intelligence Bureau has asked the premier telecom body, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), to block all Internet telephony until security systems to trace the same are in place.

The Intelligence Bureau is of the view that currently, India does not have the capabilities to track internet telephony calls – both domestic & international – and had asked the DoT find an “early solution to this issue in the interest of national security”.

The ‘recommendation’ comes in the wake of last year’s 26/11 attacks in Mumbai, where the terrorists used this medium for communication.

“The terrorists used net telephony as they were aware that India did not have the technological capabilities to do a live trace of such calls,” Cyber security expert Vijay Mukhi told Economic Times. “In the US and Europe, all players who offer

cheaper, the sound quality is also much better. The government could work out an agreement with the main players in this regard. Consumers should not suffer as a result of government’s inaction,” Mukhi added.

The jury is still out on the necessity of such an extreme step. On the one hand, the important of security cannot be taken lightly any more in the light of recent events across the world; on the other hand, curbing advances in technology that enable better communications do not benefit anyone. What’s your take?

It’s official: Indians love Google, Gmail, Orkut, Google Maps, YouTube and Blogger

Here at Digit, we are all absolutely addicted to Google products. Everyone uses Gmail as their default client, Google Maps is the default mapping engine for us and let’s not even get into the realms of actual search and video-sharing. We all know who dominates there!

So it doesn’t come as a huge surprise to us when ComScore says that Google and its product constitute

with it accounting for a mere 16.2 per cent.

Out of all the statistics, the only one which caught us off guard was how dominant Orkut was. We had no doubt that it would be the market leader, but the amount of share it has is staggering, considering how few people we know who prefer it to Facebook now.

Apart from India, only Brazil shares such high Google usage, with it topping the list at 29.8 per cent of all Internet usage in that country.

So why is Google so popular in these two emerging economies? ComScore has a possible explanation.

“As it turns out, there are interesting similarities between Brazil and India as emerging Internet markets,” Alex Banks, managing director of comScore Latin America. “Google’s prevalence in these markets can perhaps best be explained by the fact that the time at which these markets really began to develop and flourish was around the same time that Google was becoming a major player in the search landscape. As a result, Google became the dominant Internet brand in these markets and its success appears to have bled from search into other areas of the Web like social networking.”

It’s Go time for PSP Go

The guys at GameSpot UK got their hands on the new PlayStation Portable Go – the latest version of the handheld console from Sony – and have just posted a detailed unboxing video of the same on their site.

A couple of things stand out in the video, with the most promising new feature being the inclusion of the ability to pause your game. In the old PSP-3000 and all previous versions, the best you could do was quit the game if you wanted to perform some other task, such as watching a video. But in the new PSP Go, you can simply pause the game (although it takes a lot of time to do so), go back to the

XrossMediaBar and head over to the videos section to watch a movie.

This feature could be especially handy for games with checkpoints that are too far and few in-between. We have also found ourselves sometimes wishing for a feature like this when travelling in a crowded train. As playing the game becomes impossible, the option of pausing it to listen to music and then resume the game later, right where we left off, is absolutely fantastic in our books. Round of applause here, please?

Apart from that, the other big change is that the PSP Go comes with a proprietary cable now. Gone are the days of using just any micro-USB cable you have handy with your PSP; Sony



is back to its ‘use our cables and make us rich’ nonsense again.

Part of the reason for this might be the fact that the PSP Go does not come with a TV-out port like the older versions. The GameSpot reviewers surmised that the new proprietary port might double up as a TV-out port – with another proprietary cable that you will have to buy, of course.

Both the reviewers were also impressed with the build quality of the PSP Go, noting that the slider mechanism feels good, the analog nub has more resistance, the chrome buttons on the edge feel better than the plastic ones of old, and overall, the console has a ‘solid, but lighter’ feel to it.

One line in the review did bother us though: Apparently the PSP Go can be synced up to only PCs and not Macs. Is this Sony’s way of welcoming the iPod Touch to the world of handheld video game consoles? **d**



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VOIP services have provisions that allow governments to track these calls. Many of them have also installed equipment at their premises to monitor VOIP calls upon orders from governments.”

According to a report by telecom regulator TRAI, consumers used over 130 million minutes of Internet telephony in the January-March quarter of this year. This report also adds that 34 ISPs in India offer net telephony services in India legally.

“This is a good move and it will also make the ISPs compliant to law,” Mukhi told rediff.com. “We cannot obviously stop all the players as there are thousands of them but it can help to a large extent by blocking all the main players.”

“This will hit consumers very badly. Not only are the calls

an amazing 28.9 per cent of the share of total time that Indians spend online. Apparently, of the total 21,799 minutes that Indians (aged over 15) spent on the Internet (at work or home) in July 2009, 6,294 of those were used on navigating Google sites.

Google accounted for 88.4 per cent of all searches conducted, and had commanding share of time spent in social networking with Orkut (68.2 per cent), maps with Google Maps (63.9 per cent) and multimedia with YouTube (82.8 per cent). It also commanded slightly less than half of all time spent in the blogs category with Blogger (47.6 per cent) and email with Gmail (46.8 per cent).

The one disappointment for Google would be the fact that its photo-sharing service Picasa has simply not taken off in India,



Check out the PSP Go video at <http://thinkdigit.com/d/47687/>